

mc

"C" stands for CTRL and "A" stands for ALT (Midnight Commander convention).

You can also use ESC instead of ALT (useful on MacBooks).

File / directory operations

Shortcut	Action
F3	View file
Shift + F3	View raw file (ignore extension)
Shift + F4	Create a new file
F5	Copy selected files
F6	Move selected files
Shift + F6	Rename file under cursor
C-x d	Compare directories
C-x c	Chmod dialog
C-x o	Chown dialog
C-x C-s	Edit symlink
C-x s	Create symlink dialog
C-x l	Create hard link dialog
C-x v	Run relative symbolic link tool (on selected/tagged items)
C-x a	List active VFS directories

Selection

Shortcut	Action
Insert / C-t	Select/deselect file
*	Invert selection on files
+	Specify file selection options (including custom pattern)
-	Same as above, but for deselecting

Navigation

Shortcut	Action
Tab / / / C-i	Switch panel
F9	Focus top menu bar
Esc Esc	Dismiss menus/pop-ups quickly
A-c	Quick cd dialog
A-?	Search dialog
C-s	Search for item
A-s	Incremental search (press again = next match)
A-y	Previous directory in history
A-u	Next directory in history
A-Shift-h	Show path history
C-\	Directory hotlist
C-p / Up	Move selection to previous entry
C-n / Down	Move selection to next entry
A-g	First visible item
A-r	Middle item
A-j	Last visible item
A-v / Page Up	Page up
A-p / Page Down	Page down
A-< / Home	Top (first entry)
A-> / End	Bottom (last entry)

Display

Shortcut	Action
C-r	Refresh current panel
C-u	Swap panels
A-,	Toggle panel layout (horizontal/vertical)
C-x i	Toggle other panel: info mode
C-x q	Toggle other panel: quick view mode
A-i	Make other panel show same dir as current

Shortcut	Action
A-o	Show highlighted dir contents in other panel
A-t	Change panel view (full / brief / long)
A-.	Toggle "Show hidden files"

Command prompt

Shortcut	Action
C-o	Drop to console
A-Enter	Put highlighted file name on command line
C-x t	Put selected items names on command line
C-Shift-Enter	Put full path of highlighted file on command line
A-a / C-x p	Put pane directory full path on command line
A-h	Show command history
A-n / A-p	Navigate command history
C-x !	External panelize (fill panel with command output)
C-x j	Show background jobs
F2-@	Run a command on the highlighted item (e.g. unzip / zip -r <u>foo.zip</u> / 7za x / 7za a foo.7z)

Other

Shortcut	Action
Shift + F10	Quiet exit (no confirmation)

File view

Shortcut	Action
C-f	View next file
C-b	View previous file